Collect: *Deus, qui nos beati martyris tui Caesarii annua solemnitate laetificas, concede propitius, ut cujus natalitia colimus, etiam actiones imitemur.*

To-day the Würzburg List prescribes the passage from St John (xii, 24–26), *Amen, amen dico vobis: nisi granum frumenti*, as on the feast of St Lawrence.

Super Oblata. Hostias tibi, Domine, beati Caesarii martyris tui dicatas meritis benignus assume, et ad perpetuum nobis tribue provenire subsidium.

Ad Complendum. Quaesumus omnipotens Deus, ut qui caelestia alimenta percepimus, intercedente beato Caesario martyre tuo, per haec contra omnia adversa muniamur.

Even after the ninth century, when Rome introduced the feast of All Saints on the calends of November, the commemoration of St Caesarius remained in all the medieval Missals almost until the time of the Tridentine reform.

This is, therefore, a distinctly Roman feast, confirmed by the tradition of many centuries and only removed from the calendar when the Eternal City had forgotten the ancient *cultus* of St Caesarius. At the present time the festival of the holy Deacon is only kept at the monastery once dedicated to him near the tomb of St Paul.

NOVEMBER 1

Feast of All Saints

The progress of Autumn with the fall of the withered leaves, the long cycle of Sundays after Pentecost inspiring that feeling of sadness and weariness which pervades the latter part, call our minds to the solemn thoughts of eternity and of the world beyond the grave, to which we draw ever nearer as years and months pass by.

The Seer of Patmos comes to-day to anticipate the close of that long cycle symbolizing the arduous life of the Church militant: he raises a corner of the veil and shows us the Church triumphant in all her splendour.

At the beginning of this liturgical period which extends from Pentecost to Advent, it was said that the Holy Spirit would glorify Jesus: *Ille me clarificabit.* To-day we see in what manner he has kept his promise and has poured forth upon the mystical body of the Saviour such sanctity as now bears fruit in this great glory.

A collective feast of all martyrs, connected with the triumph of Christ's Resurrection, was known in Syria in the fourth century. At Byzantium, however, it was celebrated on the

Sunday following Pentecost, a custom which at one time was introduced at Rome, as is proved by the ancient *Comes* published by Morin from the well-known Codex of Würzburg : *Dominica in natale Sanctorum.*

This festival brought from Byzantium to the banks of the Tiber was short lived. An ancient tradition prescribed that the Romans should keep the solemn fast of Ember days in the week following Whit Sunday, and also the great vigil of St Peter's. It was, therefore, impossible after so fatiguing a night Office to celebrate the feast of All Saints on the same morning. The Byzantine custom was abandoned, and the festival of May 13 in honour of the martyrs instituted by Boniface IV, when he consecrated the Pantheon as a Christian Church, alone remained.

The idea of a collective feast of all the saints and not of the martyrs only, continued, however, to gain ground. At a time when the Iconoclasts in the East were destroying the sacred ikons and relics and that in Italy, in Lazio, the cemeteries of the martyrs were deserted on account of the raids of the Lombards in the campagna round Rome, Gregory III built an oratory at St Peter's in honour of all the Saints, confessors as well as martyrs, who had died in all parts of the world. A choir of monks carried out the liturgical offices of that Vatican sanctuary, and in the Mass a daily commemoration was made of all the saints whose *natalis* was celebrated on that day in the various churches of Christendom.

The reason which determined the choice of November 1 for the feast of All Saints is not certain. The change occurred under Gregory IV (827–844), with the co-operation of Louis the Pious and the Frankish episcopate ; but it has not yet been proved whether it was the Pope or the Emperor who took the initiative in the matter. Sixtus IV subsequently added the celebration of an octave to the feast.

The Introit *Gaudeamus . . . sub honore Sanctorum omnium,* is an ancient one, originally assigned to the feast of St Agatha on February 5.

On all other days of the year the Liturgy celebrates the memory of one or more individual saints. To-day the Lord *multiplicavit gentem et magnificavit laetitiam,* as Isaias says. Thus the glorification of Christ and of the Church is complete on this feast.

The Spirit of the Lord like the mysterious aromatic oil described by the Psalmist is diffused through the entire mystical body of Christ, sanctifying even the most lowly member, and preparing it thus for the highest glory.

Apostles and martyrs, clergy and laity, labourers and even slaves, all these have received the Paraclete and have been raised to heroic sanctity. This is the thought which inspires the Introit to-day.

The Collect is already to be found in the Gelasian Sacramentary, and is assigned to a collective feast of the Apostles, celebrated within the Octave of SS Peter and Paul.

Collect: "Almighty and everlasting God, by whose grace we pay honour to the merits of all thy saints on this single festival day; inasmuch as so many are pleading for us, grant us, we beseech thee, the fulness of thy mercy, for which we long."

The Lesson, and this is significant of the origin of the feast, is the same as for the dedication of the Pantheon, May 13 (Apocalypse, viii, 2–12). The Seer of Patmos beheld a gate opened before him, through which an immense multitude entered heaven. Not only the hundred and forty-four thousand predestined sons of Abraham, but a *turba magna* of every age, sex, and condition enter through Jesus, who is the gate of heaven. It is not then so hard to be saved, as St John writes that he could not count the number of the elect.

One condition is however essential. Those who reach the port of salvation are sealed on the forehead with a seal which is a sign of membership or conformity with the Eternal Father and his Christ. This seal, according to Ezechiel, has the shape of a Tau and is impressed upon the forehead of those who weep and lament. *Signa Tau super frontem virorum gementium et dolentium.* The Apostle explains the meaning of this when he teaches us that *sicut socii passionum estis et consolationis eritis*, that is to say, the future glory will be in proportion to the share we have had here in the passion of Christ.

The Gradual *Timete Dominum* is the same as on August 8 for St Cyriacus. The alleluiatic verse is a preparation for the Gospel. Jesus invites those who faint beneath the cross to come to him and he will give them refreshment.

On the day when the Church keeps the feast of All the Saints the Gospel can be no other than that of the Beatitudes (Matt. v, 1–12). All are included in it and to each is granted a special blessing. Illustrious birth, a distinguished position, ability and knowledge are not necessary here; on the contrary those who have least according to the world receive a larger share of the heavenly gift, and therefore the first Beatitude is promised to the humble and poor in spirit,

that is to say to those who have stripped themselves and have become lowly like the child whom Jesus set as a model before his disciples.

The Antiphon for the Offertory is set to a fine Gregorian melody somewhat resembling that of the *Stetit Angelus*, and is the same as for St Hippolytus, August 13.

The persecutor believes that the lives of the martyrs are in his hands, but they are in the hands of God. The wicked are merely his instruments which he uses to perfect his works of art. Thus, rage and hatred only exist in the heart of the persecutor, but the divine artist and his living masterpiece absorbed in the ideal which they pursue are full of the undisturbed peace which is necessary for the perfecting of every work of supreme genius.

The Secret is as follows: "We offer to thee, O Lord, the gifts of our devotion; let them be well-pleasing to thee for the sake of all the saints; and of thy mercy let them avail also for our salvation."

The medieval Sacramentaries contain this Preface to-day: *Vere dignum . . . aeterne Deus: et clementiam tuam suppliciter obsecrare, ut cum exsultantibus sanctis in caelestis regni cubilibus gaudia nostra subiungas. Et quos virtutis imitatione non possumus sequi, debitae venerationis contingamus affectu, per Christum*, etc.

The Antiphon for the Communion is taken from to-day's Gospel of the Beatitudes. The world has an insatiable thirst for happiness and here the Eternal Truth teaches men how to attain it, as standing on the Mount, he sets forth as it were the decalogue of happiness. Blessed are those whose heart is clean, for they shall see God; blessed are those who keep their hearts untroubled, for they shall be known as the true sons of God, the author of peace; blessed are those who endure persecution for the cause of virtue, for they will receive endless life and joy in exchange for the life and joy they have sacrificed here.

This is the Post-Communion: "Grant, we beseech thee, O Lord, that thy faithful people may ever rejoice in paying reverence to all the saints, and may be helped by their unceasing prayers."

Let us consider the expressive word by which the Liturgy describes the Church militant. "The faithful people," that is to say the people journeying towards eternity with the eyes, and in the light of faith. What is the reward of this Catholic faith, professed and practised without wavering, and which alone gives a man the right to be called "faithful"? *Fides quid tibi praestat?* the Church still asks her catechumens. And they reply: *vitam aeternam.*

We take pleasure in reproducing here the beautiful inscription composed by Pope Damasus in memory of all the saints interred in the Cemetery of Callixtus.

HIC · CONGESTA · IACET · QVAERIS · SI · TVRBA · PIORVM
CORPORA · SANCTORVM · RETINENT · VENERANDA · SEPVLCHRA
SVBLIMES · ANIMAS · RAPVIT · SIBI · REGIA · CAELI
HIC · COMITES · XYSTI · PORTENT · QVI · EX · HOSTE · TROPHAEA
HIC · NVMERVS · PROCERVM · SERVAT · QVI · ALTARIA · CHRISTI
HIC · POSITVS · LONGA · QVI · VIXIT · IN · PACE · SACERDOS
HIC · CONFESSORES · SANCTI · QVOS · GRAECIA · MISIT
HIC · IVVENES · PVERIQVE · SENES · CASTIQVE · NEPOTES
QVIS · MAGE · VIRGINEVM · PLACVIT · RETINERE · PVDOREM
HIC · FATEOR · DAMASVS · VOLVI · MEA · CONDERE · MEMBRA
SED · CINERES · TIMVI · SANCTOS · VEXARE · PIORVM

" Here are gathered, if you would know, a number of the just, for these venerable sepulchres hold the bodies of many saints. The kingdom of heaven possesses their sublime souls. Here are the companions of Sixtus bearing the trophies of their victory. Here are the Pontiffs who serve the altars of Christ. Here lies the priest whose life was spent in constant peace. Here are the holy confessors sent from Greece. Here are youths, children, old men, and their chaste descendants who chose to keep their virginal purity intact. I, Damasus, too, desired to lay my bones here, but I feared to disturb the holy ashes of the Saints."

This inscription was placed in the vault of the Popes of the third century where the four deacons beheaded with Sixtus II were buried beside him (*Comites Xysti*.)

The *numerus procerum* mentioned in the fifth line, refers to the series of Popes from Zephyrinus to Miltiades who with the exception of Callixtus, Marcellinus, and Marcellus were interred in the Cemetery of Callixtus.

The *Sacerdos* who spent his days in *longa pace* is generally supposed to be Pope Militiades, the Pontiff who finally beheld the Church at peace under Constantine the Great.

The *Confessores Sancti quos Graecia misit* are without any doubt the martyrs Hippolytus, Neonus, Maria, Hadria, Paulina, etc., buried in the so-called " arenaria " of Hippolytus, whilst of the *juvenes castique pueri* who kept their virginity undefiled, especial mention may be made of the acolyte Tarcisius and the martyr Cecilia who rest near by.

Damasus, from humility, refused the honour of burial beside his predecessors in the papal vault. But in order to be near the martyrs, he imitated the example of Pope Marcus,